FLEXISAF INTERNSHIP | SUMMER 2026

AcadTrack

Transcript Request and Tracking Portal

Project Documentation

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PROGRAMME

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Live app: acad-track-three.vercel.app

1. Overview

AcadTrack is a web portal for requesting and tracking university transcripts. A student can submit a request online and check how far it has gone, and a records administrator can go through the incoming requests and update their status as the work is done.

The idea behind it is simple: students should not have to keep walking to the records office, or messaging around, just to find out whether their request has been received. Everything about a request sits in one place.

2. The Problem

Getting a transcript usually means going back and forth between the student and the academic records office. When requests come in through different channels, a student often cannot tell whether theirs has been received, reviewed, processed or finished. Staff also lack a clear list of what is waiting and what has already been dealt with.

AcadTrack tries to fix this with one request form, a page where students follow their requests, and an admin side for managing them.

3. Aim and Objectives

The aim is to build a working portal for submitting and tracking transcript requests. The specific objectives were to:

- let students submit transcript requests online;
- give students a dashboard showing their requests and the current status of each;
- give administrators a place to review requests and change their status;
- produce a downloadable sample transcript PDF for completed digital requests;
- put into practice frontend development, API communication, data handling and deployment.

4. Scope

The project covers student registration and login (for demonstration), a student dashboard, request submission, request history and details, status tracking, an admin dashboard, status updates by the admin, and sample transcript PDF generation.

AcadTrack is a prototype. It is not linked to any official university student information system, and the transcript it generates is only a sample. It should not be treated as, or passed off as, an official academic transcript.

5. Users and What They Can Do

Student	Registers or logs in, submits a transcript request, sees their own requests, opens a request to check its details and status, and downloads the sample transcript once a digital request is completed.
Administrator	Views all submitted requests, searches or filters them, opens a request, updates its processing status, and can download the sample transcript for completed requests.

6. Functional Requirements

- A student can create an account and log in through the demonstration login flow.
- A student can submit a request with their details, the purpose of the request and the delivery method.
- Request information is saved through the backend API.
- A student can only see requests that belong to their own account.
- Each request shows its status and a progress timeline.
- An administrator can view requests and change their status.
- A sample transcript PDF is available for eligible completed requests.

7. Non-Functional Requirements

- Usability: both student and admin pages should be easy to follow.
- Maintainability: the React code is split into reusable components, pages and context/API modules.
- Availability: frontend and backend are hosted separately so the app can be reached online.
- Responsiveness: the layout is meant to work on common desktop and mobile screens.
- Consistency: statuses and request details are shown the same way everywhere.

8. How the System Is Used

Student: the student opens the app, registers or logs in, and lands on the dashboard. From there they submit a transcript request, then find it under My Requests. Opening the request shows its details and status. Once it is completed and meets the digital-delivery condition, they can download the sample PDF.

Administrator: the administrator logs in and opens the admin dashboard, looks through the list of requests, opens one, and updates its status. When processing is finished, the request is marked completed.

9. Technologies Used

React 19	Builds the user interface from components and pages.
Vite	Runs the development server and creates the production build.
Tailwind CSS 4	Handles styling and responsive layout.
React Router	Moves the user between pages of the app.
Axios	Sends HTTP requests from the frontend to the API.
JSON Server	Gives a simple REST-style API on top of the project's JSON data file.
html2pdf.js	Turns the transcript view into a downloadable PDF.
Vercel	Hosts the frontend.
Render	Hosts the backend API.

10. System Architecture

The frontend and backend are deployed separately. The React app runs on Vercel and talks to a JSON Server API on Render using Axios. The API serves the collections the app needs, mainly accounts and requests.

In short, the flow is: user's browser, then the React frontend on Vercel, then Axios requests, then the JSON Server API on Render, then the JSON data file.

The API base URL is set in `src/api.js` and points to the deployed Render service. When the project is run locally and no environment variable is given, it falls back to a local address.

11. Data Design

Data is kept in a JSON file served by JSON Server. The two main collections are **accounts** and **requests**.

Accounts support the demo login and separate student users from administrators.

Requests hold the details of each transcript request. The fields used are studentId, fullName, matricNumber, faculty, department, requestType, purpose, deliveryMethod, requestId, status, timeline and completedAt.

The studentId field is what the student pages use to filter requests, so each student only sees their own. The status field records which stage the request has reached.

12. Request Statuses

A request moves through these stages: Submitted, Under Review, Processing, Approved, Ready for Collection, Completed, and Rejected. The progress timeline on each request shows the student where it currently stands.

13. Testing and Results

The app was tested by going through its main workflows while it was being built, and again during final checks. The things checked were:

- opening the deployed app in a browser;
- registering a student account and logging in;
- submitting a request and confirming it shows up in that student's list;
- confirming that request lists are filtered by the logged-in student's identifier;
- logging in as an administrator and viewing the submitted requests;
- changing a request's status and checking the new status displays correctly;
- downloading the sample transcript PDF from both the student and admin views.

The deployed frontend is at https://acad-track-three.vercel.app/ and the backend API is at https://acadtrack-api.onrender.com/.

14. Deployment

Frontend and backend are deployed as two services. Vercel builds the React app from the GitHub repository and serves it. Render runs the JSON Server backend and makes the API available over HTTPS. The frontend reaches the backend through the configured API base URL.

15. Limitations

- It is a prototype and is not connected to any official university records database or student information system.
- The login is for demonstration only and is not secure enough for real use.
- JSON Server and the current hosting setup work for a demo, but they cannot replace a proper database and a secured backend.
- The transcript is sample content, not an official academic record.
- On free hosting the service may go to sleep and data may not persist, so availability of data should not be relied on.

16. Future Improvements

- Move to a real database and a secured backend.
- Add stronger authentication, authorization and password handling.

- Connect to approved university records systems and verified student data.
- Send email or in-app notifications when a request status changes.
- Add audit logs and fuller reporting for administrators.

17. Conclusion

AcadTrack puts transcript request submission, tracking and admin processing into one web application, and produces a sample PDF for completed digital requests. Building it gave me hands-on practice with React, working with an API, handling data, generating PDFs, using GitHub for version control, and deploying to the cloud.

18. Project Links

Live application: https://acad-track-three.vercel.app/

GitHub repository: https://github.com/OkunyomihOghenetega/AcadTrack

Backend API: https://acadtrack-api.onrender.com/